Samat Imanalin

Technical Game Designer · Researcher · Producer

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Portfolio

RESEARCH

ACADEMIC RESEARCH

- Pursued an exploratory research line on a demographic of 50+ PC gamers, including literature review and research design. *Master's Thesis*
- Organised and conducted semi-structured interviews; performed thematic analysis to surface key findings. *Master's Thesis*
- Formulated data-driven conclusions accounting for study limitations; compiled findings into a presentable report. *Master's Thesis*

INDUSTRY RESEARCH

- Conducted research into the state and challenges of game developers in the Breda region to identify organisational priorities. *Breda Game City*
- Compiled and presented research reports to the board to directly inform strategic decision-making. *Breda Game City*
- Consolidated post-release player feedback into a structured FAQ, improving the customer support pipeline. *Railway Empire 2*

PRODUCTION

TARGET AUDIENCE RESEARCH

- Conducted qualitative research into the needs and behaviours of a 50+ PC gamer demographic to inform design decisions. *Master's Thesis*
- Researched game developers in the Breda region to define the organisation's community focus and programming. *Breda Game City*

COMMUNITY & EVENT ORGANISATION

- Organised and hosted monthly networking events for the local game development community. *Breda Game City*
- Supported and elevated the Breda game development scene by connecting studios, developers and industry partners. *Breda Game City*

COMMUNICATION & COORDINATION

- Managed internal board communication and external outreach to partner organisations and game studios. *Breda Game City*
- Coordinated cross-functional collaboration within multidisciplinary teams of up to 30 people across different cultural environments.

GAME DEVELOPMENT

SYSTEMS & MECHANICS DESIGN

- Concepted, designed and implemented player abilities and level ingredients using UE4 Blueprint visual scripting. *Child of Lothian*
- Proposed and prototyped rebalancing of game mechanics to create meaningful player choices and drive engagement. *Railway Empire 2*
- Concepted, developed and integrated a player journal into an existing UI system. *Child of Lothian*

QA & BALANCING

- Conducted QA across multiple pre-release game builds. *Railway Empire 2*
- Assisted in campaign and scenario balancing; took full ownership of balancing and partial rework of 2 scenarios. *Railway Empire 2*

WORLD BUILDING & AUDIO

- Enhanced open-world interactivity by developing and placing reactive environment objects. *Child of Lothian*
- Set up collectable functionality and placed collectables throughout the game world. *Child of Lothian*
- Implemented dialogue and UI audio using FL Studio and UE4. *Child of Lothian*

EDUCATION

Breda University of Applied Sciences
MSc Game Technologies
Sep 2024 – Sep 2025
Qualitative research & data analysis

Breda University of Applied Sciences
BSc Creative Media & Game Technologies
Sep 2019 – Jun 2023
Specialisation: Design & Production

HARD SKILLS

- Blueprint visual scripting
- Game systems prototyping
- Game design documentation
- Audio creation & implementation
- Playtesting & iteration
- UI/UX design
- Qualitative data analysis
- Semi-structured interviewing

SOFT SKILLS

- Team communication (30+ people)
- Cross-cultural collaboration
- Multidisciplinary teamwork
- Creative problem-solving
- Stakeholder reporting

SOFTWARE

Unreal Engine · Perforce
Jira · MaxQDA
FL Studio
Adobe Illustrator

LANGUAGES

English
Russian
Kazakh